UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

Civil Services (Preliminary Exam) - 2020

GENERAL STUDIES : PAPER-I

Time : 2 hours **(Exam date : 04.10.2020)** **Maximum Number : 200**

ANCIENT HISTORY

• Pre-Historic Period

1. With reference to the history of India, consider the following pairs :

Famous Place — Present State

1. Bhilsa – Madhya Pradesh
2. Dwarasamudra – Maharashtra
3. Girinagar – Gujarat
4. Sthanesvara – Uttar Pradesh

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

(a) 1 and 3 only (b) 1 and 4 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 2 and 4only

Ans. (a) : The correct sequence is as follows–

Famous place		Present State
1. Bhilsa	–	Madhya Pradesh
2. Dwarasamudra	–	Karnataka
3. Girinagar	–	Gujarat
4. Sthanesvara	–	Haryana

Therefore, of the above option Bhilsa and Girinagar are correctly matched.

• Vedic Civilization (Buddhism)

2. With reference to the cultural history of India, which one of the following is the correct description of the term 'paramitas'?

(a) The earliest Dharmashastra texts written in aphoristic (sutra) style
(b) Philosophical schools that did not accept the authority of Vedas
(c) Perfections whose attainment led to the Bodhisattva path
(d) Powerful merchant guilds of early medieval South India

Ans. (c) : Paramita is commonly known as 'Perfections' (Pararmis) that a pilgrim to achieve in course of 'Nirvana'. The Fourth Noble Truth, the Noble Eightfold Path gives what the Buddhist pilgrim (practitioner) has to practice and the path which he has to follow, to achieve enlightenment and realize Nirvana. A parallel path consists of perfecting certain qualities, which leads the pilgrim to becoming a Samma Sambuddha, a self enlightened Universal Buddha. The qualities are called the Paramis (perfections) in the Southern traditions and the Paramitas in the Eastern and Northern traditions. The elements of the Noble Path and the Paramis (Qualites) are similar.

The Ten Paramis are:
1. Generosity, 2. Morality, 3. Wisdom, 4. Energy, 5. Truthfulness, 6. Determination, 7. Loving-Kindness, 8. Renunciation, 9. Patience, 10. Equanimity.
The ten Paramitas of the Eastern and Northern tradition are :
1. Generosity, 2. Morality, 3. Patience, 4. Energy, 5. Meditation, 6. Wisdom, 7. Skilful means, 8. Resolution, 9. Power, 10. Knowledge.
Despite slight differences in the wording, the two sets of qualities are similar.

• Buddhism, Jainism, Bhagavata, Shaiva and other Religion

3. With reference to the cultural history of India, consider the following pairs-

1. Parivrajaka – Renunciant and Wanderer
2. Shramana – Priest with a high status
3. Upasaka – Lay follower of Buddhism

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b): The correct answer is as follows :

(1) Parivrajaka – Renunciant and Wanderer (A wandering religious mendicant)
(2) Shramana – The Buddhist and Jain monks were called Shramans.
(3) Upasaka – Lay followers of Buddhism.

Therefore, it is clear from the given option that Shramana was not correctly matched.

4. With reference to the religious history of India, consider the following statements:

1. Sthaviravadins belong to Mahayana Buddhism
2. Lokottaravadin sect was an offshoot of Mahasanghika sect of Buddhism
3. The deification of Buddha by Mahasanghikas fostered the Mahayana Buddhism

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b) : The division of the Buddhist Community in India in the first three centuries following the death of the Buddha in 483 B·C· . The first division occurred as a result of the Second Buddhist Council, held 100 years after the Buddha's death, at Vaishali. This council was called to condemn certain practices of some monks which were contrary to the Vinaya or Monk' code of conduct. When the Acariyavadins (followers of the traditional teaching) split away from the Sthaviravadins (followers of the way of the elders) and formed their own school, known as the Mahasanghikas.
These sthaviravadins followed a realist line, stating that all phenomena exist and are unstable compounds of elements. They taught that it is necessary for all humans to strive for Arahantship or release from the constant round of rebirth (Samsara). They taught that Buddhas are men-pure and simple, rejecting any notion of their being transcendental. The other group, which were in the majority were known as the Mahasanghikas. Like the Sthaviravadins, they accepted the fundamental doctrines as taught by the Buddha. Such as the four noble truths, but they differed in believing that Buddhas are supermundane and transcendental. They also believed that the original nature of the mind is pure and that is contaminated when it is stained by passions and defilements. It was from the Mahasanghikas that the Mahayana was to evolve. Hence statement 1 is not correct. They continue to differ significantly from the Sthaviravada in how they understood the nature of the Buddha and they are the first to attribute divinity to him and represent him in the anthropomorphic form in statuary, setting a precedent that has continued to the present day. Hence statement 3 is correct. Further subdivisions of the Mahasanghikas over the next seven centuries included sect of Lokottarvadins whose philosophy was based on Lokottara Buddha or supernatural Buddha's concept Ekavyavaharikas and the Kaukkutikas. Hence statement 2 is correct.

• Mauryan and Post Mauryan Period

5. Who among the following rulers advised his subjects through this inscription?
"Whosoever praises his religious sect or blames other sects out of excessive devotion to his own sect, with the view of glorifying his own sect, he rather injures his own sect very severely"

(a) Ashoka (b) Samudragupta
(c) Harshavardhana (d) Krishnadeva Raya

Ans. (a) : In India, rock inscription was popularised by Ashoka. The total number of Ashoka's inscriptions is 14. James Princep had deciphered an inscription in 1837 written in Brahrmi script which referred to a king called 'Devanampiya Piyadasi'. The XII Major Rock Edicts of Ashoka mentions his religious tolerance, it talks about respect for all sects. The given line "whosoever praises his religious sect or blames other sects with a view of glorifying his own sect, he rather injuries his own sect very severely", is mentioned on XII Edicts (Ashokan Inscription).

• South India

6. Consider the following events in the history of India:

1. Rise of Pratiharas under King Bhoja
2. Establishment of Pallava power under Mahendravarman-I
3. Establishment of Chola power by Parantaka-I
4. Pala dynasty founded by Gopala

What is the correct chronological order of the above events, starting from the earliest time?

(a) 2 – 1 – 4 – 3 (b) 3 – 1 – 4 – 2
(c) 2 – 4 – 1 – 3 (d) 3 – 4 – 1 – 2

Ans. (c): The correct chronology–

Mahendravarman-I	–	600-630 A.D.
Gopala	–	750-770 A.D.
Mihir Bhoja	–	836-886 A.D.
Parantaka I	–	907-955 A.D.

7. Which of the following phrases defines the nature of the 'Hundi' generally referred to in the sources of the Post-Harsha period?

(a) An advisory issued by the king to his subordinates
(b) A diary to be maintained for daily accounts
(c) A bill of exchange
(d) An order from the feudal lord to his subordinates

Ans. (c) : In India, instruments of credit have been in use since time immemorial and are popularly known as 'Hundi'. The movement of goods during the medieval period was facilitated by the growth of a financial system that permitted easy transfer of money from one part of the country to another. This was done through the use of 'Hundis'. The 'Hundis' was a letter of credit payable after a period of time at a discount.

• Gupta and Post-Gupta Period

8. With reference to the period of Gupta dynasty in ancient India, the towns Ghantasala, Kadura and Chaul were well known as–

(a) Ports handling foreign trade
(b) Capitals of powerful kingdoms
(c) Places of exquisite stone art and architecture
(d) Important Buddhist pilgrimage centres